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ALL PUBLICATION MATERIAL DUE BY THE 12TH OF THE MONTH - PRIOR TO MONTH OF NEWSLETTER

DATES FOR YOUR CALENDAR

1st Aug - Wainui, Waitoki & KKK Church Combined Service
12th August - Waitoki Coffee Group Meet
15th August - Hands-On Wainui Church
15th August - KKK Library Photo Collection
29th August - KCPC Bee Keeping workshop

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The WAINUI & WAITOKI WATCH

2021 AUGUST

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10 Top Gardening Tips for Beginners
BEE Keeping Workshop
Phelan's Local Board Update

hello darling

Hello Darling store is almost six years old. Owned by Waitoki locals, originally in Silverdale Village they moved to Millwater last year. The move allowed for a larger store and for them to be a part of a larger community.
It's a gorgeous family run store, a mix of homewares, bespoke furniture and beautiful NZ fashion labels. They stock Kate Sylvester, Karen Walker, Trelise Cooper, Gregory, Twenty-seven names and La Tribe to name a few, together with Saben handbags and Stolen Girlfriends jewellery.
Each year they raise money for a charity, 2021 was a Pink Ribbon event. The store is a collection of things they love and hope that you will too. They are open Monday to Saturday at 7/177 Millwater Parkway, Millwater or visit them online at www.hellodarling.co.nz

OLLIFFFARM

premium pasture eggs

OLLIFF FARM GOES FROM STRENGTH TO STRENGTH

After what has been a turbulent past year for most, Olliff Farm have come out on top and are continuing to excel, going from strength to strength.
Being acknowledged as one of the best in the country for their revived age-old practice of raising chooks on their Silverdale property, Dean and Deonne Olliff are creating eggs that are full of flavour, nutrient dense, and are truly like no other.
Wowing a judging panel of 30, including Head Judge and food expert Laurine Jacobs, Olliff Farm were recently awarded a GOLD medal at the 2021 Outstanding Food Producers Awards. With a record number of over 300 products entered, Olliff Farm's premium pasture eggs are now recognised as one of the finest products in the country.
Not only did they impress the judges with their outstanding eggs, Olliff Farm was also chosen by the general public as the "People's Choice" Outstanding Food Producer of the Year. This is an exceptional achievement from this local and innovative business, and we are proud to have them as part of our local community.
If you haven't tried these golden nuggets yet, they are a must! You can purchase via their website **www.olliffarm.co.nz** & pick up directly from their farm.

PHELAN'S LOCAL BOARD UPDATE
July 2021

Local Board members recently had an opportunity to speak at a public meeting organised by Kumeu Community Action about our roles. Auckland Council was established in 2010 with a very different system of local governance than Rodney District Council. A decade on there is still a lot of confusion about what we do on the Local Board so we jump at any opportunity to discuss this with the community.

Local Boards are part of a co governance arrangement. On one side of this is the 20 Auckland councillors and mayor that make up a 'governing body' that set rates, make decisions about regional facilities, set bylaws, and allocate budgets to 'council controlled organisations' such as Auckland Transport and Watercare. On the other side are Local Boards that are responsible for local parks and facilities such as halls and playgrounds and have a role advocating to councillors on behalf of the community.
Transport infrastructure is a top issue for our community and the expectation is that the Local Board should be able to sort this out. Unfortunately, it isn't that simple. Councillors set the strategic direction and budgets for Auckland Transport which is responsible for our local roads (but not State Highway 16 which is the responsibility of central government). How Auckland Transport then implement this is an operational decision that the Local Board has very little control over. We do advocate to councillors for improvements like an increased maintenance budget, but advocacy is very different from being able to control and prioritise budgets like we are able to do on our local parks.

By the time you read this we hope that an increase in maintenance funding will have been approved by councillors. So how will this change things on our roads?
The system used for road maintenance is to a large degree reactive, so if particular roads have a lot of issues, they will be prioritised for renewal or maintenance.
Logging issues such as potholes or safety issues with Auckland Transport quickly is critical. The IT system they use direct reports to the contractors for action, this should mean that depending on the scale of the issue something is done quickly. A simple pothole may be patched, however if there is an underlying issue, for example, a problem with the road foundation, then a temporary fix may be used until a more complex solution can be implemented.

Whether it's a damaged bus stop, footpath or road the sooner someone logs an issue with Auckland Transport the sooner it can be sorted out. I have logged potholes that have been dealt with quickly, in most cases within 48 hours.

The best way to do this is online. Google 'report a problem Auckland Transport' and the top hit will take you to the start of the reporting process. If you want to be notified of progress, make sure you provide your contact email address.
Taking a few minutes to log problems will help Auckland Transport build a picture of local problem spots and increase the likelihood of longer terms solutions to underlying maintenance or safety issues.

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Phelan Pirrie
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KAIPARA COAST PLANT CENTRE
Bee Keeping Workshop
Sunday 29th August
9.30am to 11.30am

If you are thinking of establishing hives on your property or would just like to know some more about these amazing little creatures then this is an ideal workshop for you to attend.

This event will give a great overview not only of the techniques employed to nurture bees but also costs and time associated with the activity as well as what you will achieve. Kim will also offer tips on how to make your garden more "bee friendly".

Our guest presenter is Kim Kneijber who has worked with Bees for over 15 Years, is a life member of the Auckland Bee Keeping Club and has a long time association with APINZ.
Kim will cover many facets associated with this fascinating subject including:

- Challenges facing the bee population
- Hive maintenance & positioning
- Equipment required
- Pros & cons of bee keeping
- Rules & compliance issues
- Safety considerations

There will also be a working hive on site plus the centre has now established a "Bee friendly" plant section. You will also be able to explore our extended 3.5km nature trail. Booking is advised as this event is very popular and numbers are limited

We also have our cute little coffee shop on site plus of course the Plant Centre for you to browse through (including the new Bee friendly plant section).

Our knowledgeable and friendly staff will also be on hand to help with any garden related questions.

Venue location: 1481 Kaipara Coast Highway (SH16), 4km north of Kaukapakapa
Tickets: $20 per person.
To Book: info@kaiparacoast.co.nz
OR Phone: 09 420 5655

WAITOKI AND WAINUI COMMUNITY CHURCHES

The Waitoki Coffee Morning meets on the 2nd Thursday of the month. Our special programme on 12 August will feature entertainer Rex Kingi. Rex will be singing Maori and folk songs. He has previously been awarded as the best performing male country artist. 10.00am at the Waitoki Community Church. A gold coin donation for morning tea appreciated. Contact: Wally & Leoni May 022 109 7933.
Hands-on Church Wainui meets in the Wainui Hall on the 3rd Sunday of the month. At 11.00am on Sunday 15 August we will have an interactive all-aged programme continuing the Joseph story from Genesis. All welcome. Contact: Andrew Gamman 021 168 2808
Waitoki, Wainui and Kaukapakapa Churches Combined Service
After a successful combined service at All Saints Kaukapakapa last month, the churches will combine again at 11.00am Sunday 1 August at Waitoki Community Church. The preacher will be Rev Suresh Chandra. Contact: Andrew Gamman 021 168 2808.
Leon Reynolds performing at the at the Waitoki Coffee Morning in July.

Leon is a flautist. He brought with him a collection of flutes old and new and, as well as playing, gave an interesting talk on the history and development of the flute.

KAUKAPAKAPA LIBRARY
The Stevens Photo Collection
Sunday 15th August,
9am to 1pm

Since the historic Kaukapakapa library reopened the doors seven years ago, there has been a variety of events from authors through to photography, often with an underlying theme of the history of the area. The library began in 1865 when pioneer Morris Henley opened his home and his literary collection to other residents for their enjoyment. The present building came into being in 1911 and has moved around the village four times before coming to rest beside the Village Hall. Opening in 2014 in conjunction with the Kaukapakapa Village Market, the library has been the grateful recipient of much local history and also become a place for some of the newer residents to find out more about the past of the district.

Recently received has been a collection of old Kaukapakapa photos courtesy of the late Ina Stevens of Waitoki. While many of these are already incorporated in the Jordan Collection, there are also many I haven't seen before. As always seems to be the way, a number of photos have no details with regard to names or place. Come along to the library and see if you can help us solve some of these mysteries. For more info contact Megan Paterson 021 959017 or threehorses@xtra.co.nz

10 TOP GARDENING TIPS FOR BEGINNERS

Wondering how to start a garden? Find your confidence with these expert gardening tips.

Never gardened before? No problem. Make your grow-you-own dreams a reality with these 10 easy-to-follow tips.

1. Site it right. Starting a garden is just like real estate it's all about location. Place your garden in a part of your yard where you'll see it regularly (out of sight, out of mind definitely applies to gardening). That way, you'll be much more likely to spend time in it.
2. Follow the sun. Misjudging sunlight is a common pitfall when you're first learning to garden. Pay attention to how sunlight plays through your yard before choosing a spot for your garden. Most edible plants, including many vegetables, herbs, and fruits, need at least 6 hours of sun in order to thrive.
3. Stay close to water. One of the best gardening tips you'll ever get is to plan your new garden near a water source. Make sure you can run a hose to your garden site, so you don't have to lug water to it each time your plants get thirsty. The best way to tell if plants need watering is to push a finger an inch down into the soil (that's about one knuckle deep). If it's dry, it's time to water.
4. Start with great soil.
When starting a garden, one of the top pieces of advice is to invest in soil that is nutrient-rich and well-drained.
5. Consider containers. When space is at a premium, look to containers. You can grow many plants in pots, including vegetables, herbs, flowers, fruit trees, berries, and shrubs. When gardening in containers, use a pot that's large enough for the plant it's hosting
6. Choose the right plants. It's important to select plants that match your growing conditions. This means putting sun-loving plants into a sunny spot, choosing heat-tolerant plants in warm climates, and giving ground-gobbling vines like pumpkins and melons ample elbow room (or a trellis to climb). Do your homework and pick varieties that will grow well where you live and in the space you have.
7. Discover your zone. Knowing your "hardiness zone" can help you choose the best plants. Simply put, it describes the coldest place a plant can grow.
8. Learn your frost dates. Planting too early (or late) in the season can spell disaster for your garden. You need to know the last average spring frost date for your area so you don't accidentally kill plants by putting them out prematurely. It's also good to know your first average fall frost date so that you get your plants harvested or moved indoors before late-season cold damages them.
9. Add some mulch. Apply a layer of mulch that's 2 to 3 inches deep around each plant. This will help reduce weeds by blocking out the sun, and reduce moisture loss through evaporation, so you have to water less.
10. Feed plants regularly. We've already talked about the importance of starting with great soil, but that soil works best in concert with regular boosts of high-quality nutrition for your plants. In other words, amazing soil + top-notch plant food = super garden success! So, a month after planting, begin feeding your garden.

Stock up on the basic tools you need to make it easier to grow. Happy growing!

HELENSVILLE MUSEUM
Ka Mua Ka Muri - Our Past is our Future

It's been a daunting task for the Helensville Museum to take back control from the pests - a couple of months turned into two years of hard work to get everything frozen, but the freezer container has finally been removed.
No more visits into the -28 degrees freezer, no more struggling to open the door that had frozen shut, no more days of lifting, loading and shifting.
There's still plenty to do re-staging rooms, unpacking, cataloguing and archiving items, but the Museum will now be partially open Monday to Wednesday, 10am to 12pm, and by appointment for groups.

Entry is Koha until the museum is fully opened in the near future. Come along and find out what's been going on behind the scenes, you may feel inspired to volunteer! All helpers are welcome.
For more info please contact the Museum **(09)4207881**, or helensvillemuseum@xtra.co.nz

Waitoki Village Market Day Saturday 14th August - 8.30am to 12.00pm
Problems with your Project?
Want to know how to knit, crochet, cast on or off, read a pattern, or solve a dilemma? Come and meet the happy bunch of crafters who are members of the Waitoki Evening Craft Group. They'll be the ones laughing and talking over needles, hooks and wheels at the next Waitoki Market.
Bring along your hitches, someone's always ready to help and discuss the possibilities of a project.
Lots to see and you can pick up homemade and preloved bargains, baked goods, preserves, plants and more, while sampling a delicious BBQ brunch, or just catch up with the neighbours, it's good to know them before you need them!

Waitoki Hall, Kahikatea Flat Rd. 8.30 till noon Saturday August 14th.
Support your community; proceeds from the Market go back to our local community.
New stall holders welcome, contact Gill 420 3301 or email waitokihall@gmail.com
Future Dates: 9th October, 11th December